# Lesson 7.1: Wājibāt of Ṣalāh

Ṣalāh is made up of different parts. In today's lesson, we will learn all the wājib acts of ṣalāh, along with the rukn and ghayr rukn parts.

## The Wājib Acts of Ṣalāh

There are 11 acts that are wājib in ṣalāh:

1. Niyyah: Before we learn the 10 actions we must remember that niyyah or your intention is a wājib prerequisite to all wājib actions. You must know why you are doing something and for whom.
2. Takbīrat ul-iḥrām (the first Allāhu Akbar)
3. Qiyām (standing still while performing takbīrat ul-iḥrām, reciting the qirāʾah, right before rukūʿ, and after rukūʿ.
4. Rukūʿ (bowing down)
5. Sajdatayn (two prostrations)
6. Qirāʾah (recitation of Sūrah al-Fātiḥah and another sūrah)
7. Dhikr (the recitations in rukūʿ and sajdah)
8. Tashahhud (the recitation while you sit after the two sajdahs in the second and last rakʿah)
9. Salām (salutation)
10. Tartīb (correct order)
11. Muwālāt (continuity — one action after the other without a long delay)

## Rukn & Ghayr Rukn

Ṣalāh is like a building that is made up of many parts: some of these parts form the foundation of the building, while others are just built upon the foundation. If the foundation gives way, then the whole building will collapse.

In the same way, the wājib acts of ṣalāh are divided into two groups: the rukn and ghayr rukn. Rukn are those wājib parts that form the foundation of ṣalāh. Ghayr rukn are those wājib parts that do not form the foundation of ṣalāh.

"Rukn," in Arabic, literally means a pillar. If you take away a pillar from something, the object will fall down. A rukn is an act that is essential to the prayer, and if it is not done, or done at the wrong time, it will void the prayer.

The arkān (plural of rukn) of a prayer are five acts: (1) niyyah, (2) takbīrat ul-iḥrām, (3) qiyām while performing the takbīrat ul-iḥrām and before rukūʿ, (4) rukūʿ, and (5) sajdatayn. If any of these are left out or added at the wrong time, it will invalidate the prayer.

It is called a rukn because it doesn't matter if the mistake (i.e., leaving the rukn out or adding it where it wasn't supposed to be) was intentional or unintentional — the prayer will still be void.

This means that if you are capable of keeping your body still, but your body is moving while you say the takbīrat ul-iḥrām, even by mistake, your ṣalāh is not correct.

Ghayr rukn, on the other hand, refers to obligatory acts of prayer that, if left out or

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added at the wrong time, will invalidate the prayer only if done intentionally. The prayer will still be valid if it is done unintentionally.

The ghayr rukn actions include qirāʾah, dhikr, tashahhud, salām, tartīb, and muwālāt. So, for example, if you accidentally sit while reciting the sūrahs or right after the rukūʿ, then your ṣalāh would still be correct. However, if you *intentionally* sit in either of these cases, your ṣalāh will not be correct.

### Rukn Parts of Ṣalāh

The following five wājib acts are rukn:

1. Niyyah
2. Takbīrat ul-iḥrām
3. Qiyām while performing the takbīrat ul-iḥrām and before rukūʿ
4. Rukūʿ
5. Sajdatayn (both sajdahs — one sajdah by itself is not a rukn)

### Ghayr Rukn Parts of Ṣalāh

The following six wājib acts are ghayr rukn:

1. Qirāʾah (recitation of Sūrah al-Fātiḥah and another sūrah)
2. Dhikr (the recitations in rukūʿ and sajdah)
3. Tashahhud (the recitation while you sit after the two sajdahs in the second and last rakʿah)
4. Salām (salutation)
5. Tartīb (correct order)
6. Muwālāt (continuity — one action after the other without a long delay)